

Pennsylvania State University – Competitive Cyber Security Organization

Date of Origin: September 2014

Last Updated: September 2026

Registered Student Organization Name: Pennsylvania State University – Competitive Cyber Security Organization, known herein as CCSO.

Article I – Name and Affiliation

Name

The official name of this organization shall be the Pennsylvania State University – Competitive Cyber Security Organization, known herein as CCSO.

Affiliation

CCSO is not affiliated with any national organization; it is local to the University Park campus.

Article II – Mission Statement

Purpose

The purpose of the Penn State Competitive Cyber Security Organization (CCSO) is to provide members with opportunities to pursue their interests in all facets of cybersecurity, develop their technical skills, collaborate with alumni and other organizations, and provide mentorship opportunities.

Mission

The mission of CCSO is to develop the technical skills and knowledge of our members and provide them with the opportunity to apply themselves by participating in various cybersecurity competitions.

Goal

The goal of CCSO is to develop our members and represent Penn State in cybersecurity competitions.

Article III – Membership

- At all times, the majority (50%+1) of all active members shall be full-time, officially registered students at University Park.

- The membership shall be divided into active and associate members.
- Only currently registered students who have paid club dues are eligible for active membership.
- All other members interested in dedicating themselves to the purpose of the Penn State Competitive Cyber Security Organization, including but not limited to, faculty, students from other Penn State campuses, staff, and community members, shall be associate members.
- Only active members may hold office, vote, preside, officiate, solicit funds on behalf of the organization, or represent the organization in competitions.
- At all times there shall be at least 10 active student members. A list of active members must be maintained by the organization.
- The club reserves the right to expel a member who is not following the policies of the organization with a super-majority vote (75%) of attending members.
- All members, including but not limited to new members and recruits, reserve the right to refrain from participating in any activities without consequence, based upon personal/religious beliefs, personal values, or moral reserve as defined by the member.
- Any interaction/activity between members and/or new members will be limited to guidelines stated by university policy, as well as local, state, and federal laws.

New Members and Recruitment

Any new members will be given full disclosure during recruitment, including but not limited to the disclosure of:

1. New Membership Manual (if applicable).
2. Schedule of New Member Events and Activities (if applicable).
3. A list of all responsibilities.
4. A copy of the University Hazing Policy, prescribed by Policies and Rules for Student Organizations. This document is available upon request by the Office of Student Activities.

Non-Hazing Compliance Statement

The CCSO and The Pennsylvania State University does not tolerate hazing. Hazing is prohibited for any University recognized or sanctioned organization, student, or other person associated with an organization operating under the sanction of or recognized by the University.

Organizations or individuals found responsible for hazing under this Policy, whether occurring on or off campus, will be subject to disciplinary action by the University, and may also face criminal charges under state law, including The Timothy J. Piazza Antihazing Law, 18 Pa. C.S. § 2801, et seq.

Annually, the CCSO will share the University Hazing Policy with the entire membership, prescribed by Policies and Rules for Student Organizations.

Non-Discrimination Statement

CCSO, following the University's Non-Discrimination Policy, will not discriminate membership based on any protected class outlined at Penn State Policy AD-91.

Membership Mediation

In the case of violations of constitutional policies and/or a conflict between members within the organization, the highest-ranking officer that is not involved in the conflict, with assistance from the advisor (if applicable), will facilitate an informal mediation procedure:

The mediator shall:

1. Arrange for a mediation meeting outside of the regular organization business meeting.
2. Explain their role as the impartial party and the objectives of the mediation.
3. Set ground rules.
4. Allow each party to express their views by allowing the conversation to go where the parties wish it to go.
5. Collect any available resources that might assist in the resolution (financial documents, emails, photos, etc.).
6. As a third party, do not suggest resolutions but rather leave the responsibility for the resolution with the parties involved.
7. Facilitate goal setting to reach a win-win resolution.

Membership Removal

The club reserves the right to expel a member who is not following the policies of the organization with a super-majority vote (75%) of attending members.

Article IV – Officers

In accordance with University policy, co-President and co-Treasurer positions are not permitted; the President and Treasurer positions may not be held by the same student at the same time.

- Undergraduate candidates must be full-time, officially registered active student members to be selected as an officer, captain, or chair at the time of the appointment or election. Graduate candidates may be full-time or part-time, officially registered active student members to be selected as an officer, captain, or chair at the time of the appointment or election. Officers, captains, and chairs may change from full-time to part-time, or vice versa, after starting their role. The organization may establish and apply additional eligibility criteria for appointed or elected leaders/officers upon a super-majority (75%) vote.
- Active members may be elected to officer positions according to the rules in the Election of Officers section below.
- The Officers should meet at least once a week when possible. This should include captains and chairs for at least a portion of the meeting.
- The Officers should meet with the advisor at least three (3) times a semester to coordinate efforts and discuss opportunities.

Executive Officers

President (required position)

1. The President is the spokesperson of the organization and the primary contact for all external communication. The President may delegate communication as they see fit.
2. The President defines the vision and goals that the club will work towards during their term.
3. The President is responsible for leading the organization and directing efforts.
4. The goal of the President will be to ensure the organization is serving its members.

Vice-President

1. The Vice-President shall serve as the President when the President is unable to do so.
2. The Vice-President shall serve as the Tech Director when the position is vacant.
3. The Vice-President will preside over the Offensive and Defensive captains to support the competitive teams. Responsibilities include tracking registration dates, facilitating travel, and oversight of activities.
4. The goal of the Vice-President will be to support the President and to ensure the long-term success of the organization.

Treasurer (required position)

1. The Treasurer will be responsible for all organizational finances and will keep an up-to-date budget.
2. The Treasurer will be responsible for all UPAC and ASA meetings and interactions.
3. The Treasurer will collect and track membership dues each semester.
4. The Treasurer will oversee the corporate engagement program, work closely with the Sponsorship Chair, and maintain a list of affiliated corporations.
5. The Treasurer will plan and book reservations for all club travel unless otherwise decided by the President and Vice-President.
6. The goal of the Treasurer will be to keep the organization financially stable and to fully benefit from all available University funding and resources.

Secretary

1. The Secretary is responsible for ensuring all organizational needs are met. This includes but is not limited to sending bi-weekly announcements, maintaining OrgCentral, and updating organizational documents.
2. The Secretary is responsible for yearly club merchandise orders and distribution. This includes but is not limited to conducting interest surveys, defining pricing, placing the order, and delivering merchandise.
3. The Secretary shall serve as the Competition Chair when the position is vacant.
4. The goal of the Secretary will be to enhance engagement and ensure our members are benefiting from the organization.

Event Planner (required position)

1. The Event Planner will lead the Social Team and is responsible for planned activities excluding competitions, including but not limited to booking university spaces and organizing participation in involvement fairs.
2. The Event Planner will maintain a master schedule for the academic year listing all events.

3. The Event Planner will be responsible for facilitating the Involvement Fair each semester. This includes but is not limited to scheduling people to be present at the table, creating the posterboard, and facilitating recruiting activities.
4. The Event Planner shall serve as the Recruitment and Social chair when the positions are vacant.
5. The goal of the Event Planner will be to plan and support organization events, outreach and community engagement.

Tech Director

1. The Tech Director will lead the Tech Team and is responsible for the overall strategy and management of all technical resources within the organization. This includes but is not limited to the organization's communication channels, club domain names, and club infrastructure.
2. The Tech Director will facilitate the technological resources for any club activities.
3. The Tech Director will serve as the Webmaster when the position is vacant.
4. The goal of the Tech Director will be managing and maintaining the technical resources of the club to facilitate trainings, competitions, and club image.

Captains

- Following elections and at least one week prior to the end of the Spring semester, the Executive Board shall appoint the Offensive Captain, Defensive Captain, and CTF Captain for the upcoming academic year by a majority vote.
- The Executive Board shall solicit recommendations for new Captains from the outgoing Captains, and shall also accept statements of interest from active members.
- Newly appointed captains fully assume their roles and responsibilities at the end of the Spring semester.
- Active members may be appointed to captain positions by a majority vote of the Executive Board.
- The President may appoint active members to a vacant captain position without a vote with consent from the Vice-President.
- Active members may hold a single officer or captain position at a time.
- Captains may hold an Officer position with the approval of both the current President and club Advisor.

Offensive, Defensive, and CTF Captains

1. Each captain position can only be held by one individual. No one may hold multiple captain positions simultaneously.
2. The Offensive and Defensive Captains will lead the CPTC and CCDC competition teams respectively, as well as any other non-CTF cybersecurity competitions unless otherwise decided by the President.
3. The CTF Captain will identify and promote CTF competitions throughout the year, select teams, and organize practices or delegate the organization of practices to individual teams.
4. The CTF Captain will organize SillyCTF, an annual public CTF competition in the Spring semester, with support from the Executive Board. The CTF Captain may

delegate this task.

5. The CTF Captain will organize The Conspiracy, an annual Alternate Reality Game in the Fall semester, with support from the Executive Board. The CTF Captain may delegate this task.
6. The Offensive and Defensive Captains will hold open meetings focused on their respective cybersecurity topics at least three (3) times a semester.
7. The Offensive and Defensive Captains must hold tryouts for the CPTC and CCDC competitive teams before the end of September.
8. The Captains must have a detailed training plan prior to the start of the semester that must be approved by the President and Vice-President.
9. The goal of the captain positions will be to gain hands-on leadership experience in a security-focused environment and represent Penn State at various competitive events.

Chairs

- The President may appoint active members to a chair position without a vote with consent from the Vice-President.
- The President may create, modify, or dismiss chair positions without a vote with consent from the Vice-President.
- There is no limit on the number of chair positions that can be created. In addition to individual chair roles, formal teams may be established to manage specific club functions.
- There are no restrictions on the number of chair positions a member can hold.
- Responsibilities of Officers can be delegated to chair positions as needed, within reason. Created chair positions should report to their respective officer.
- Disputes over unfair delegation or workloads should follow the informal mediation process.
- The constitutional list of chair positions is non-exhaustive.
- Filling vacancies: If there is a sudden vacancy for an officer position, nominations must be taken at the meeting following the vacancy. Refer to the rules in the Election of Officers section below.

Tech Team

The Tech Team is responsible for the design, implementation, and maintenance of all club technical infrastructure. This includes systems supporting competitions, educational resources, and the club's online presence. The team works collaboratively to provide a stable technical environment for all members.

The Tech Team is led by the Tech Director, see Tech Director role documentation in the Executive Officers section above. All team members report to the Tech Director.

Team Roles and Responsibilities:

- **Cloud Systems Administrator**
 1. Manages and maintains all cloud-based infrastructure, primarily utilizing platforms such as Kubernetes, Oracle Cloud, and Rancher.
 2. Responsible for cloud service provisioning, identity and access management (IAM), and managing the club's domain names and DNS records.

- **On-Premises Systems Administrator**

1. Manages and maintains all physical and locally hosted club infrastructure, including servers, networking equipment, and virtualization platforms (e.g., OpenStack, Kubernetes, Ansible).
2. Responsible for hardware maintenance, operating system patching, and ensuring the availability of on-premises lab environments.

- **Webmaster**

1. Maintains the organization’s public-facing online platforms, including the official website, social media accounts, and the Discord server.
2. Responsible for content updates, theme management, and ensuring a positive user experience on all club platforms.

- **CTF Creation Chair**

1. Leads the development, testing, and deployment of Capture The Flag (CTF) challenges for use in club meetings, workshops, and recruitment events.
2. Works closely with the Systems Administrators to deploy challenges on the appropriate infrastructure.

- **Resource Developer**

1. Creates and curates technical and educational content for the club, such as workshops, resources, and documentation.
2. Manages the club’s knowledge base (e.g., wiki or Git repository) to ensure resources are organized and accessible to all members.

Social Team

The Social Team manages recruitment, internal events, public branding, and corporate relationships to ensure the club’s sustained growth and engagement.

The Social Team is led by the Event Planner, see Event Planner role documentation in the Executive Officers section above. All team members report to the Event Planner, though the Sponsorship Chair will also work closely with the Treasurer and President.

Team Roles and Responsibilities:

- **Sponsorship Chair**

1. Actively seeks out and communicates with potential corporate sponsors and industry partners to secure funding, resources, and guest speakers for the organization.
2. Maintains relationships with existing sponsors and coordinates closely with the Treasurer to manage incoming corporate funds and compliance with university policies.
3. Documents contacts within the Wiki as needed.

- **Social Chair**

1. The Social Chair shall plan, organize, and execute at least 2 social and fundraising events per semester.
2. The Social Chair will report to the Event Planner unless otherwise decided by the President.

- **Recruitment Chair**

1. The Recruitment Chair shall plan and organize recruitment events such as the

Involvement Fair.

2. The Recruitment Chair will report to the Event Planner unless otherwise decided by the President.

- **Social Media Design Chair**

1. Creates high-quality digital and print graphics, flyers, and promotional materials for club events, meetings, and announcements.
2. Manages the club's branding and ensures engaging content is posted across all social media platforms regularly.

Election of Officers

- Officer elections shall take place during a regularly scheduled meeting more than a month prior to the end of the Spring semester.
- Newly elected officers fully assume their roles and responsibilities at the end of the Spring semester.
- This meeting shall be publicized at least 1 month in advance and in the meetings preceding it and through all organizational communication platforms such as Discord and email.

Election codes:

1. Nominees for the role of President must have previously held an Officer, Captain, or Chair role in the organization for at least 1 semester. Should no one meet these criteria, any active member may be nominated.
2. All active members may cast a single vote per office.
3. Any member may nominate an active member for an office prior to the election. Candidates must accept their nomination prior to elections.
4. Candidates must prepare a brief presentation in support of their candidacy, and answer questions from members.
5. Members must be present to vote.
6. The specific format for elections and nominations may be determined by the President with majority consent from the Executive Board.
7. If a simple majority (50%+1) cannot be obtained by a single candidate, the candidate with the lowest number of votes shall be dropped from consideration and the active members shall vote again.
8. In the event of a tie, the ballots will be recast.
9. No one involved in conducting the elections may be an official candidate.

Officer Removal

- In the event an officer or captain is not fulfilling their duties as outlined by the President and in the Officers or Captains sections respectively, they meet grounds for dismissal from their position.
- The President and Vice-President may issue a verbal or written warning outlining the officer or captain in question's failed duties and other misconduct as applicable.
- After a warning is issued, the officer or captain in question will begin a two-week probationary period where they can address the grievances cited in the warning.
- If after the probationary period, the officer or captain in question is still not meeting

the expectations outlined in the warning, the Executive Board and chairs can vote to remove the officer or captain using a two-thirds majority.

- If the officer or captain in question believes any part of this proceeding to be unfair or unfounded, these disputes can be discussed with the club advisor.

Officer Replacement

In the event an officer or captain steps down, or a position is vacant, the following steps should be taken to replace the officer or captain:

1. The officer or captain stepping down must provide a minimum of two weeks' notice that they are stepping down.
2. Upon notice of an officer stepping down, the Executive Board must begin electing a replacement officer using the rules in the Election of Officers section above.
3. Upon notice of a captain stepping down, the Executive Board must appoint a new captain as defined in the Captains section above.
4. An interim officer or captain may be appointed by the President and Vice-President as needed until the officer or captain position is officially filled.

Article V – Operating Procedure

Meetings

- The Penn State Competitive Cyber Security Organization will meet at least once per month.
- Adequate advance notice about the date, time, and location of the meeting must be given to all active members.
- The President, with the consent of the Vice-President, may change the meeting frequency.
- The President may call special meetings at their discretion.

Decision-Making Process

- A quorum for all voting shall be thirty-three percent (33%) of the active members. If an active member does not attend four (4) meetings in a row or misses two meetings with votes, they are not counted when forming a quorum.
- Only active members may vote.
- A simple majority (50%+1) of the present, active members is required for a vote to succeed unless otherwise stated.
- The President shall not cast a vote unless it is a tie-breaking vote.
- The method and format for voting may be determined by the President with majority consent from the Executive Board.
- The method and format for voting must be reasonable and cannot be used to exclude active members from voting.

Amending the Constitution

- Amendments to this constitution may be introduced at any time. Voting must take

place at least a week after an amendment's introduction.

- Any active member can introduce an amendment.
- Voting shall occur at the meeting following an amendment's introduction. Prior to voting, there must be a discussion about the proposed changes.
- Upon a successful vote, the amendment takes effect following Office of Student Activities approval.
- The organization's advisor must be notified of proposed constitution changes at least a week in advance and withholds the right to veto constitutional amendments.

Parliamentary Authority

Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised, by Sarah Corbin Roberts shall be used in all cases not covered by this constitution.

Accessibility of this Constitution

Copies of this constitution shall be made available to anyone upon request.

Article VI – Advisors

- This organization must always retain at least one advisor. The advisor will be a full-time Faculty or Staff member of The Pennsylvania State University, University Park campus and will be chosen by the organization.
- This organization will choose an advisor through a majority vote.
- The Advisor shall not vote as an active member and shall solely act at the discretion of the Executive Board.

Duties of the Advisor

- The Advisor shall serve as an official representative for the Penn State Competitive Cyber Security Organization when required by a competition.
- The Advisor shall serve as an intermediary between the Penn State Competitive Cyber Security Organization and The Pennsylvania State University or the College of Information Sciences and Technology.

Article VII – Financial Statement

Finances

- All organizational funds are to be deposited and handled exclusively through the Associated Student Activities (ASA).
- This organization will not have an off-campus account(s).
- This organization will collect reasonable dues if and only if:
 1. The dues are not excessive.
 2. There is a proven need for dues as income for the organization.
 3. Dues are determined by the Treasurer with consent from the President.

- Dues shall be collected semi-annually.

Spending

- The use of organizational funds for competition travel, preparation, registration, or other uses must be approved by either the Treasurer or the majority of the Executive Board.
- All other uses of organizational funds require both Treasurer approval and majority consent from the Executive Board.
- If a dispute about the use of organizational funds cannot be resolved, follow the outlined informal mediation process.

Article VIII – Enabling Clause

This Constitution was reviewed and ratified by the Executive Board on March 24, 2026, at a regular body meeting.

The entire membership and Executive Board have reviewed and agree to this document.

Additional Procedures

Competition Teams

Tryouts

- The Offensive and Defensive Captains must hold tryouts for the CPTC and CCDC competitive teams before the end of September.
- Each tryout should consist of a hands-on exercise that provides a fair assessment of skills required to be a successful member of the competition team.
- Captains may solicit help from other members, alumni, or associate members to build the tryout exercise. If possible, only members not planning to participate in tryouts should assist with the creation of the exercise. Otherwise, another fair evaluation must be provided by the captain for that member.
- The result of these tryouts may be used to determine the makeup of other competition teams, such as CyberForce. It's encouraged to hold a tryout exercise for all competitions involving travel.

Team Selection

- For competitions that do not have an associated tryout, captains may use an application form to select their teams.
- Team captains have the final say over team selection.
- If a competition has alternate members, the team captain is free to determine the process of selecting both alternates and full members. This process must be made clear in advance to all involved team members, ideally at tryouts/application.
- Captains must confer with the advisor and the highest level Executive Board member

- not seeking a spot on the team to confirm their team selections.
- Teams should be selected in a fair manner that emphasizes the skills required to be a successful member of the competition team.

Advisor Approval

Any competition that requires or references advisor involvement, whether for travel or virtual participation, must receive advisor approval prior to registration. The advisor must be informed of their role and responsibilities before registration is completed. No member may sign on behalf of an advisor or submit documentation bearing an advisor's name without their explicit written consent. Failure to follow this process will be reviewed by the organization's advisor, who will determine appropriate corrective action, which may include removal from the team, removal from the leadership position, or further administrative action.